ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	21st Commission Meeting
DATE:	18 March 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	Proposal on implementing IVR for vulnerable positions – DoPS *Following up on the decision of the 9th Commission Meeting held on 07 January 2026 regarding the identification professions for mandating the IVR, CFD presented the proposed framework as follows:* • *proposed for adoption the term "**prone to corruption risk**" in place of "**vulnerable**".* • *presented a four-factor assessment framework to determine professions prone to corruption risks, comprising:* *(i) extent of public service delivery and citizen interaction;* *(ii) authority over allocation and decision-making on resources, properties, and facilities;* *(iii) management or custody of significant financial resources and related decision-making powers; and* *(iv) authority over key human resource management decisions.* *These factors were assigned respective weightages of 25, 30, 30, and 15, and applied through a risk scoring formula to generate a heat map for classification.* *Based on the scoring, professions were categorized into following four risk levels:* ***Score** / **Risk Level*** ***75-100** / High corruption risk* ***50-74** / Moderate corruption risk* ***25-49** / Low corruption risk* ***0-24** / Minimal corruption risk*	**Endorsed with the following specific directives:** - **inform all staff to adopt the term "*prone to corruption risk*" in place of "*vulnerable*" as the standard terminology across all official documents and correspondences.** - **re-categorise Protocol Services under "*Minimal Corruption Risk*", considering the absence of public interface and resource custody.** - **ensure the inclusion of Thromde Services under the "*High Risk*" category, given the level of public interface and financial transactions involved.** - **conduct a compliance audit of the IVS in the next financial year to assess its effectiveness and impact at the ground level.**

	*The assessment identified 16 professions under high risk, 21 under moderate risk, three under low risk, and two under minimal risk, with the detailed list provided in the **Annexure**.* *Based on these findings, CFD proposed to mandate IVR for all positions at P2 and above (or equivalent), as well as for common cross-cutting functions such as procurement and stores, finance and accounts, and human resource management, irrespective of their placement in the heat map. It was further proposed to extend IVR to members of decision-making committees and other positions falling within high-risk professions.* *The Commission, however, raised concerns regarding the feasibility and appropriateness of mandating IVR for committee members, noting that such a requirement could undermine the very purpose of such mechanisms to minimize individual discretion and promote transparency in decision making, while also creating additional administrative burden for agencies. To this, CFD clarified that the proposal was not intended as a mandatory requirement and was presented for consideration on a voluntary basis by agencies.* *Once approved, the CFD plans to implement, starting with a ToT from 28-30 March 2026 for 182 focal persons, followed by a phased rollout supported by media releases and office orders, with full implementation targeted from July 2026. The training will be conducted through a mix of virtual and in-person sessions in four batches.*	
2	Update on the Evidence Vetting and CRM trainings – SS *SS apprised the Commission on two trainings conducted from 2–8 March 2026:* *i) Elementization and Evidence Vetting, attended by 35 participants, including two representatives from each Regional Office; and* *ii) CRM, attended by 16 participants, including one from each Regional Office and four from the CCAIA, MoF.* *Overall feedback indicated that the content of both trainings was well received. The Elementization and Evidence Vetting module was noted to be highly relevant for day-to-day operations and relevant even for participants from non-legal backgrounds. However, participants recommended incorporating more real-life case scenarios to enhance understanding. It was also observed that the duration of the Elementization and Evidence Vetting training was relatively short given the depth of the content, and it was suggested that the duration be extended. Participants from the CCAIA further*	**Noted with the directive to:** - **explore the use of actual case files to design simulation-based group exercises for the Elementization and Evidence Vetting training.** - **include participants from other agencies, including the OAG, in future iterations of the training.** - **Commissioner In-Charges to ensure participation of relevant officers in the Elementization and Evidence Vetting training.**

	recommended that CRM training be conducted annually as a refresher programme. *With regard to the conduct of Elementization and Evidence Vetting training to the Management, HRS proposed to conduct the session after the Commission's visit to the Regional Offices, with inclusion of officials from DoPE given its relevance to their work. It was further proposed to conduct the training outside the ACC premises at a suitable government facility to allow focused engagement.* *The Commission also deliberated on the possibility of incorporating Elementization and Evidence Vetting into the Mandatory Foundational Training and noted the need to assess its appropriateness, considering that the foundational programme primarily targets new recruits.*	
3	Draft SOP for RBP personnel on security at ACC Office – PPD & SS *SS and PPD presented the draft SOP developed by the RBP for deployment of its personnel on security duty at the ACC Head Office for the Commission's review and endorsement. In comparing the proposed SOP with the existing SOP on RBP escort services during interview, interrogation, search, seizure, arrest, and detention, SS and PPD apprised that the new SOP primarily covers the management of physical security of the ACC premises during working hours.* *While noting that the two SOPs could be consolidated, SS and PPD clarified that they serve distinct operational purposes. The SOP on security duty at the Head Office pertains specifically to arrangements with the Thimphu City Police, whereas the SOP on escort services is coordinated through the ACC focal point at the RBP Headquarters for escort services across the country. In view of these differences, it was proposed to retain the SOPs as separate documents.* *Noting that the support for security duty at the ACC Head Office was approved following long-standing requests, the Commission emphasized to proceed with its adoption in its current form and further refine it through implementation.* *Additionally, the Commission highlighted the need to engage with the RBP regarding the change of the ACC focal point at the RBP Headquarters, noting concerns related to inappropriate advice reportedly provided in to suspects during interview.*	**Endorsed with following specific directives:** - **SS to serve as the contact point for overall coordination and supervisory.** - **ensure appropriate integrity vetting and related due diligence of RBP personnel deputed for security duty at the ACC Head Office.** - **ensure that deployed RBP personnel conduct necessary security checks, including screening of bags and weapons at entry points.** - **initiate discussions with the RBP Headquarters regarding the change of the ACC focal person.**
4	Update on the implementation status of Parliament Resolution on the review of Annual Report 2024-2025 – PPD *PPD presented the resolutions of the 4th Session of the 4th Parliament (National Assembly) and 36th Session of the National Council on the review of the ACC's Annual Report 2024-2025 as follows:*	**The Commission noted that while most resolutions are either under implementation or have been initiated, a few require further follow-up. Accordingly, the Commission directed as follows:**

	a) ***National Assembly***: *i) Enforce stricter sentencing standards, with higher penalties where senior officials are involved to reinforce deterrence and accountability.* *ii) Institutionalize preventive systems by mandating AIMS across all budgetary agencies that capture both preventive efforts and actual corruption occurrences.* *iii) Introduce a system to incentivize integrity and accountability in leadership.* *iv) Strengthen integrity in law enforcement and regulatory agencies, embedding anti-corruption values in their mandates and culture.* *v) Integrity-based resourcing, ensuring that liabilities and living costs do not structurally undermine enforcement roles, while holding high-risk positions to the highest standards of accountability.* *vi) Specialized capacity-building resources, particularly in digital forensics, risk-based audits, and cross-border enforcement.* *vii) Preventive systems, including mandatory integrity vetting and systematic rotation of high-risk posts* *viii) Establish secure Online Government Platform for the following:* *1) Make payment online and do away with the cash payment and reduce business dealings among individuals vulnerable to collusion.* *2) Lessen human interventions by ultimately progressing towards e-procurement and ensure auditing and transparency.* *3) Ensure automated approval to subvert authority and unlimited power with individuals.* *4) Minimize human involvement by managing Human Resource through systems and aim towards making Human Resource Systems transparent and integrated.* *ix) Government to embed ethics, integrity, and anti-corruption principles into national curriculum and public service delivery frameworks.*	- **PPD to convey to the Cabinet Secretariat that the status of resolutions pertaining to the ACC will be reported through the upcoming Annual Report.** - **PPD to include discussion points on stricter sentencing standards during the meeting with the Hon'ble Chief Justice and highlight the role of Parliament in strengthening legal provisions in the forthcoming Annual Report.** - **DoPE to develop a proposal on systems to incentivize integrity and accountability in leadership and present it to the Commission.** - **PPD to further develop the initial concept paper shared with the ADB Office of Anti-Corruption and Integrity on integrity and anti-corruption programmes for law enforcement agencies.** - **PPD to propose an agenda item on the systematic rotation of high-risk posts for discussion during the upcoming Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, & RCSC.**

		x) *Good Governance Committee to present past resolutions adopted by the Parliament related to the Anti-Corruption Commission's Annual Report during the winter session.* xi) *Considering that the remote villages face challenges related to basic infrastructure, the Government should use BICMA's Universal Service Fee in improving basic infrastructure.* xii) *The Good Governance Committee to review appropriateness in establishing an administrative tribunal.* xiii) *Ensure that the burdens for acquits as adjudged either by courts or respective agencies is lessened by drawing clarity in the roles and responsibilities of Anti-Corruption Commission, Royal Audit Authority, and Office of the Attorney General based on the Acts and procedures and ensure detention and freezing of properties and bank accounts is resolved timely without undue delay based on respective mandates.* b) ***National Council**:* i) *Strengthen public sector ethical resilience through continuous value-based education, enhance preventive systems in the high-risk sectors such as procurement, construction, licensing, contract management, and public finance and promote whole-of-society engagement. Further, introduce effective integrity tools such as risk mapping, behavioral insights, proactive vulnerability scanning and promote a culture of zero tolerance.* ii) *Support adequate funding and resources to the ACC, RBP, OAG, Judiciary and allied law enforcement agencies to invest in specialized capabilities such as digital forensics, surveillance technology, financial investigations, forensic accounting and intelligence analysis. Similarly, strengthen inter-agency collaboration framework to reduce delays in referrals and prosecutions and enhance regional presence or outreach to respond promptly to corruption risks across all Dzongkhags.* iii) *Expand integrity programs across schools, universities, and local governments. Utilize*	

	behavioral insights and community-driven approaches to foster an ethical culture. *iv) Enhance its ongoing advocacy and interactive sessions to outreach greater awareness and embed anticorruption values among the larger sections of the society.* *v) Media must be protected from exposing corruption. Strengthen legal framework and collaboration between the media, ACC, OAG, Judiciary, CSOs and other oversight bodies to ensure coherent, ethical and factual reporting of corruption cases.* *In this regard, the Commission deliberated on the appropriateness of reporting the status of the above resolutions to the Cabinet, as requested by the Cabinet Secretariat vide letter No. C-4/2026/990 dated 20 January 2026. The Commission noted that the ACC traditionally reports to Parliament through its Annual Report and underscored the need to consider this established reporting framework.*	
5	Update on the Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, & RCSC – PPD *PPD apprised the Commission that the Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, and RCSC has been confirmed for 07 April 2026 (Tuesday), following the Commission's visit to the Regional Offices. PPD further updated on additional agenda items proposed by the RCSC, namely:* *i) issues related to procurement thresholds and time limits for direct contracting; and* *ii) the administrative burden on agencies arising from Action Taken Reports (ATR).* *In this regard, the Commission emphasized that ATRs should not be perceived as an administrative burden or a waste of resources, but rather as an essential institutional responsibility for agencies to address systemic weaknesses and take appropriate administrative action against malfeasance and misfeasance. The Commission also noted that, with the establishment of the ACRD, the ACC has significantly streamlined its referrals, limiting them to matters requiring immediate attention, thereby reducing the volume of administrative burden on agencies.* *From the RAA, the Commission noted that the proposed agenda items relate primarily to HR matters and maintained that HR related issues concerning the ACC will be pursued through bilateral engagement.*	**Noted and directed PPD to find out more details on the two proposed agenda items from the RCSC.**

6	Other - Call for Entries on Bhutan Media Forum Awards 2026 *The Commission discussed the invitation received from the Bhutan Media Foundation to submit nominations for initiatives by government agencies or civil servants related to media and digital communication that demonstrate innovation, measurable impact, and alignment with the public interest. The award will be assessed based on criteria including innovation and creativity, impact and outcomes, contribution to transparency and public communication, sustainability and scalability, and alignment with public interest.* *It was further noted that the winner will receive a trophy, certificate, and a cash prize of Nu. 50,000.00, and that submissions are required to be made by 25 March 2026.*	**Regret**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**